

3DS is here, finally

Nintendo's glassless 3D portable game console - the Nintendo 3DS is slated to release on March 27

Ban on gaming?

The Vietnamese government has asked ISPs to block online access to games from 10 pm to 8 am to curb the 'negative side-effects' of gaming



Retribution has a new face... A preview...

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Retribution will be the second and most likely the final standalone expansion pack for Dawn of War II, making way for Space Marine action game that is scheduled for release later this year. Retribution introduces a new faction of the human race, the Imperial Guard. The inclusion of Imperial Guard takes the number of playable races in Dawn of War II to six. It looks like Relic is building Retribution to be a grand finale to the Blood Ravens saga, with each of the six races getting their own single-player campaign.

The multiplayer mode of Dawn of War II has remained virtually untouched by Retribution, with the obvious exception of the new faction. Each of the six races

has three heroes to choose from before the start of a multiplayer session. These hero units fall in archetypical categories of offence, defense and support. With the exception of Annihilation game mode, multiplayer in Dawn of War II focuses on capturing and defending strategic points on the map. These games can be played in competitive or co-operative modes with the same overall objective of controlling territory. Resource points and power is used to keep the war machinery growing. The use of unit population cap keeps the size of opposing enemy forces in balance. With the release of Retribution, Dawn of War II has consolidated a good number of multiplayer maps across a variety of environments, locations and game types.

For the emperor

Although both factions are loyal to the Emperor, the Imperial Guard is a very different breed of combatants when compared to the Space Marines. While the Space Marines are genetically enhanced, heavily armored and deploy in small numbers, the Imperial Guard make up for their physical frailty by fighting in numbers. The Imperial Guard's units and structures are more readily recognizable as traditional instruments of war. These include use of resilient bunkers, massive tanks and a variety of infantry units that can quickly swell in numbers to overwhelm the enemy. The one common tactic between the two human factions is introduced by the religious fervor of Witch Hunter Inquisitor of the Imperial Guard.

Building on the previous

two releases, the multiplayer games in Dawn of War II are pretty solid barring some balance issues with Imperial Guard units. I found the grenadier units of the Guard being exceptionally effective at decimating enemy ground forces. Some of the reported performance issues are being addressed by the developers via patches, but I personally did not encounter any major issues with the game.

The multiplayer of Retribution is shaping up well to welcome the newest faction and there is little reason for it to be not as solid as the previous two installments. The clincher for me however is going to be the single-player campaign which will hopefully bring a satisfying resolution to the Chapter. The game is slated for release in the first week of March for Microsoft Windows. 